

CE Courses & Exam Prep — Complete Workflow Guide

Clinical Training and Supervision Academy | How Both Product Types Work | Generated: 2026-08-11 | Plugin v1.0.190

This document explains the **complete end-to-end process** for both product types in your CTA LMS: **CE Courses** (Continuing Education) and **Exam Preparation Programs**. It covers what happens on the website, what the learner experiences, what you control as admin, and what the plugin handles automatically.

Most important difference: CE courses use a **strict step-by-step path** ending in a CE certificate. Exam Prep programs use **open access** for six months with **no CE certificate** and no evaluation or attestation.

Quick Comparison

Feature	CE Course	Exam Prep Program
Product type in system	ce	exam_prep
CE credit hours	Yes (e.g. 3–15 hours)	No (0 CE hours)
CE certificate	Yes, after full completion	Never
Access duration	Permanent (purchase) or while membership active	6 months from enrollment (default)
Module locks	Yes — sequential unlock	No — all open immediately
Assessments	One Final Examination (after all modules)	Many: chapter tests, Practice A/B, Comprehensive Final
Course evaluation	Required (CAMFT-style form)	Not used
Attestation	Required (electronic signature)	Not used
Video lessons	Yes (Vimeo embeds per module)	No video — workbook HTML + downloads
Publish rule	Draft until CAMFT CEPA approval + confirmation	You control Publish / Draft directly
Where admin manages	Courses → CE Courses tab	Courses → Exam Preparation tab

Part A — CE Course Complete Process

A1. What Is a CE Course?

A **Continuing Education course** awards official CE hours to licensed mental health professionals after the learner completes all required steps. Examples in your system include California Law & Ethics CE, Telehealth, Suicide Risk Assessment, HIV/AIDS, Human Sexuality, Child Abuse, Alcoholism, and Clinical Supervision.

A2. Admin Setup (Before Learners See It)

1. Course exists in **CTA LMS → Courses → CE Courses** with title, price, CE hours, category, modules, final exam, evaluation questions, and optional downloads.
2. Status starts as **Draft** (hidden from public website).
3. After **CAMFT CEPA provider approval**, you click **Publish** and confirm the CEPA warning. Only then does the course appear on the public CE catalog and accept payment.
4. You can **Unpublish** anytime to hide from new buyers. Existing enrolled learners keep access.

Admin control rule: Published = visible + purchasable. Draft = hidden. CE publish always requires your explicit CEPA confirmation.

A3. How a Learner Finds and Buys a CE Course

1. Learner visits website → **CE Courses** catalog page ([cta_course_catalog]).
2. Only **Published** courses appear.
3. Learner opens single course page → sees description, CE hours, price, objectives.
4. Learner logs in or registers (Licensed Professional or Associate role).
5. Learner pays via **Stripe checkout** (or receives access via membership/bundle).
6. System creates an **enrollment** record and sends enrollment confirmation email.

A4. Learner Journey — Step by Step (Automatic Sequence)

The plugin enforces this order. Learners cannot skip ahead:

Step 1 — Access Dashboard

After purchase, learner opens **My Dashboard** ([cta_student_dashboard]) and sees the enrolled CE course.

Step 2 — Complete All Modules (Sequential)

- Module 1 is open; later modules stay locked until the previous module is marked complete.
- Each module may include a **Vimeo video** lesson.

- Learner clicks **Mark as Complete** or **Next Module** when finished.
- Progress percentage updates on enrollment record.

Step 3 — Final Examination

- Available only after **all modules** are complete.
- Default passing score: **70%**.
- Unlimited attempts until pass; after pass, retakes are blocked.
- Answer rationales are hidden for CE finals (exam security).

Step 4 — Course Evaluation

- CAMFT-style multi-section form (participant info, learning objective ratings, overall rating, comments).
- Questions come from the course evaluation bank (synced from CAMFT template).
- CTA-CE-001 Law & Ethics includes inline attestation inside the evaluation form.

Step 5 — Completion Attestation

- Learner types full legal name as **electronic signature**.
- Signs mandatory compliance statement; IP and date recorded.
- Skipped when evaluation already includes attestation (Law & Ethics CE).

Step 6 — CE Certificate Issued

- System generates certificate automatically when all gates pass.
- Certificate number format: **CTA-YEAR-#####**.
- Provider line: **CAMFT-Approved Continuing Education Provider | CEPA Provider #003369**.
- Issue date shown in **Pacific Time (America/Los_Angeles)**.
- Electronic signature of administrator (Candice Fuimaono, MS, LMFT) on certificate.
- Learner downloads PDF; **certificate_ready** email sent.
- Enrollment status changes to **completed**.

CE FLOW: Purchase → Modules (sequential) → Final Exam (pass) → Evaluation → Attestation → Certificate

A5. Access Rules for CE

- **Individual purchase:** permanent access; enrollment never expires.
- **Membership/bundle access:** access lasts while subscription is active; if membership ends, course access expires but **certificate remains permanent** if already issued.

- **Membership + individual purchase:** individual purchase always wins — membership cancellation cannot revoke purchased access.

Part B — Exam Preparation Program Complete Process

B1. What Is an Exam Prep Program?

An **Exam Preparation Program** is a self-paced study product for licensing exams. It does **not** award CE hours or CE certificates. Examples: LMFT/LCSW/LPCC California Law & Ethics Exam Prep, LCSW ASWB Clinical, LPCC NCMHCE, LMFT AMFTRB National, LMFT California Clinical.

B2. Admin Setup

1. Programs listed in **CTA LMS → Courses → Exam Preparation** tab.
2. Each has formal title, public display name, price, 6-month access period, and full content (workbooks, assessments, flashcards, toolkits) loaded by plugin sync.
3. You set status: **Published** (live) or **Draft** (hidden).
4. No CAMFT CEPA confirmation required for Exam Prep publish.
5. Optional: **Publish All Exam Prep** button to bulk-publish all programs.
6. You can manually extend a learner's access months from the course edit screen if needed.

Admin control rule: Published = on website catalog + checkout works. Draft = completely hidden from public. Simple on/off — no extra approval dialogs.

B3. How a Learner Finds and Buys Exam Prep

1. Learner visits **Exam Preparation** catalog page ([cta_exam_prep_catalog]).
2. Only **Published** programs appear.
3. Learner opens program page → sees description, price, 6-month access notice, "No CE Credit" classification.
4. Learner pays via Stripe checkout.
5. System creates **exam access** record with **expires_at = purchase date + 6 months**.
6. Enrollment confirmation email sent.

B4. Learner Journey — Open Access Model

Unlike CE, there is **no required sequence** and **no locks**. From day one of access:

Step 1 — Dashboard & Course Player

- Learner opens dashboard and selects the Exam Prep program.
- All workbook modules visible immediately — no waiting for previous module completion.
- Workbooks display as **online HTML lessons** in the course player with **Previous Workbook / Next Workbook** navigation.

- Printable **DOCX/PDF workbooks** available as downloads.
- **No video** in exam prep player (workbook reading only).

Step 2 — Assessments (All Open From Start)

Structure varies by program but typically includes:

Program type	Typical assessments
Law & Ethics (LMFT/LCSW/LPCC)	License module quiz, workbook/chapter tests, Practice Exam A (50q), Practice Exam B (50q), Comprehensive Final (100q)
LCSW ASWB Clinical	12 workbooks, 17-question banks, Form A & Form B (122 questions each)
LPCC NCMHCE	12 workbooks, practice banks, 3 checkpoints, Form A & Form B (143 questions each)
LMFT California Clinical	12 workbooks, Form A & Form B (150 questions each)
LMFT AMFTRB National	12 workbooks, 17-question banks, 3 checkpoints, Form A & Form B (180 questions / 240 min), 12 audio reviews

- Learner can take any assessment at any time — no module completion required first.
- Quiz rationales shown after submit (study mode).
- Unlimited retakes allowed even after passing.

Step 3 — Study Tools

- **Interactive flashcards** — flip, prev/next, shuffle (in-browser viewer).
- **Printable flashcards** and **study toolkits** as downloads.
- **Answer keys and detailed rationales** as protected downloads for offline study.

Step 4 — Access Expiry

- After **6 months**, exam access expires unless extended by admin or repurchased.
- Repurchase extends from the later of "now" or current expiry date.
- No certificate issued at any point.

EXAM PREP FLOW: Purchase → 6 months access → All workbooks + assessments + downloads OPEN → Study at own pace → Access expires (or extend/repurchase)

B5. What Exam Prep Does NOT Include

- No CE hours
- No course evaluation form
- No completion attestation

- No CE certificate
- No sequential module locks
- No membership bundle inclusion (sold separately)

Part C — Side-by-Side Admin Workflow

Task	CE Course	Exam Prep
Where to manage	Courses → CE Courses	Courses → Exam Preparation
Make live on website	Publish + CEPA confirm	Publish (one click)
Hide from website	Unpublish	Unpublish
Edit price/hours	CE hours + price in Edit	Price + access months in Edit
Edit content	Modules, final exam, evaluation, downloads	Assessments panel, downloads (most content pre-synced)
Monitor uptake	Enrollments column	Purchases column
Extend learner access	Not needed (permanent on purchase)	Exam access extension panel in Edit
Bulk action button	Restore Prices + Sync Syllabus	Publish All Exam Prep

Part D — Website Pages Learners Use

Page	Shortcode	Used for
CE Courses catalog	[cta_course_catalog]	Browse/buy CE courses
Exam Prep catalog	[cta_exam_prep_catalog]	Browse/buy Exam Prep programs
Single product page	[cta_single_course]	Course/program detail + checkout
Learner dashboard	[cta_student_dashboard]	My courses and progress
Course player	[cta_course_player]	Watch CE videos or read Exam Prep workbooks
Quiz / evaluation	[cta_quiz]	CE final exam, evaluation, attestation; Exam Prep assessments

Part E — Payment & Email (Both Product Types)

1. Learner clicks Enroll / Buy on single course page.
2. Stripe Checkout opens (card payment) — unless payments bypass is on (staging only).

3. On success: webhook + return URL finalize enrollment/exam access.
4. Emails sent: payment receipt + enrollment confirmation.
5. CE only: certificate_ready email when certificate generated.

Part F — Your Products at a Glance

CE Courses (8 in catalog)

- California Law & Ethics CE (CTA-CE-001) — 6 hrs, \$79
- Telehealth CE (CTA-CE-002) — 3 hrs, \$45
- Advanced Suicide Risk Assessment — 6 hrs, \$79
- Alcoholism & Chemical Dependency — 15 hrs, \$149
- Child Abuse & Mandated Reporting — 7 hrs, \$89
- HIV/AIDS and Mental Health — 7 hrs, \$89
- Human Sexuality & Clinical Practice — 10 hrs, \$99
- Clinical Supervision — 15 hrs, \$169

All CE courses default to Draft until you publish after CEPA approval.

Exam Prep Programs (7 in catalog)

- LMFT California Law & Ethics — \$199, 6 mo
- LCSW California Law & Ethics (CTA-EP-002) — \$199, 6 mo
- LPCC California Law & Ethics (CTA-EP-003) — \$199, 6 mo
- LMFT AMFTRB National — \$329, 6 mo
- LMFT California Clinical — \$249, 6 mo
- LCSW ASWB Clinical — \$249, 6 mo
- LPCC NCMHCE — \$249, 6 mo

You control Published/Draft for each program independently.

Summary — Remember These Three Rules

1. **CE = sequential path + certificate.** Modules lock in order → exam → evaluation → attestation → CE certificate. Publish only after CAMFT CEPA approval.
2. **Exam Prep = open study + timed access.** Everything open for 6 months. No certificate. You publish when ready.
3. **Published vs Draft** is your main lever on both: Published = website + sales; Draft = hidden.